2025 Iowa State University Farmland Value Survey

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File C2-70

The Iowa State University Land Value Survey was initiated in 1941 and is sponsored annually by Iowa State University. Only the state average and the district averages are based directly on Iowa State University survey data. County estimates are derived using a procedure that combines Iowa State University survey results with data from the US Census of Agriculture. Since 2014, the survey has been conducted by the Center for Agricultural and Rural Development in the Department of Economics at Iowa State University and Iowa State University Extension and Outreach.

The survey is intended to provide information on general land value trends, geographical land price relationships, and factors influencing the Iowa land market. The survey is not intended to provide a direct estimate for any particular piece of property.

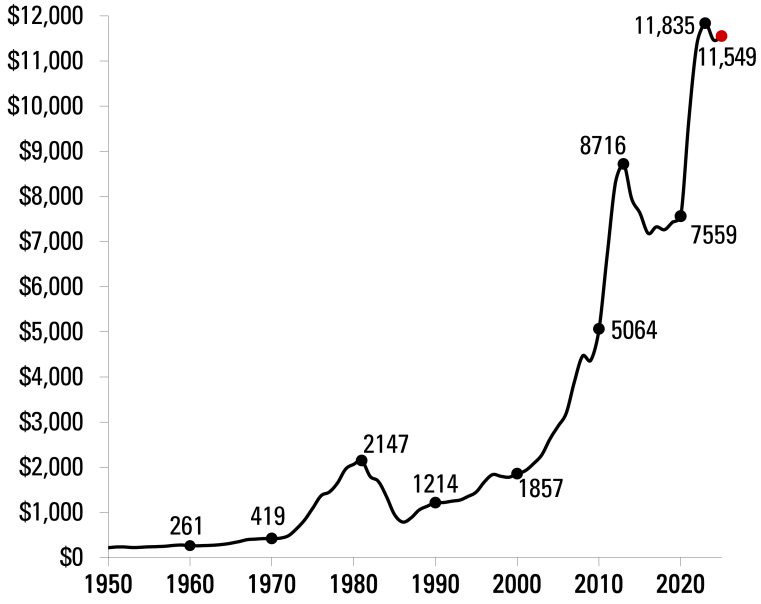
The survey is an expert opinion survey based on reports by licensed real estate brokers, farm managers, appraisers, agricultural lenders, county assessors, and selected individuals considered to be knowledgeable of land market conditions. Respondents were asked to report for more than one county if they were knowledgeable about the land markets. The 2025 ISU Land Value Survey is based on 463 usable county-level land value estimates provided by 316 agricultural professionals.

Of the 316 respondents, 69% completed the survey online. Online responses allow participants to provide estimates for up to 12 counties. The CARD Farmland portal, farmland.card.iastate.edu/, facilitates the visualization and analysis of Iowa farmland values, pooling data from Iowa State University, the United States Department of Agriculture, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, and the REALTORS® Land Institute Iowa Chapter, as well as making use of charts over time and interactive county maps.

Participants in the survey are asked to estimate the value of high-, medium-, and low-quality land in their county. Comparative sales and other factors are taken into account by the respondents in making these value estimates. This survey is the only data source that provides an annual land value estimate at the county level for each of the 99 counties in Iowa. In addition, this survey provides estimates of high-, medium-, and low-quality land at the crop reporting district and state level.

The 2025 state average for all quality of land was estimated to be $11,549 per acre as of November 1, 2025 (Figure 1). This is an increase of $83 per acre from Nov. 1, 2024, and a 0.7% increase (Table 1).

Figure 1. Average value per acre of Iowa farmland.
Source: Iowa State University Land Value Survey.



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IOWA STATE UNIVERSITY
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Table 1. Changes in Iowa farmland values, 1981-2025.

Year	Value per acre	Dollar change	Percentage change
1981	$2,147	$81	3.9%
1982	$1,801	-$346	-16.1%
1983	$1,691	-$110	-6.1%
1984	$1,357	-$334	-19.8%
1985	$948	-$409	-30.1%
1986	$787	-$161	-17.0%
1987	$875	$88	11.2%
1988	$1,054	$179	20.5%
1989	$1,139	$85	8.1%
1990	$1,214	$75	6.6%
1991	$1,219	$5	0.4%
1992	$1,249	$30	2.5%
1993	$1,275	$26	2.1%
1994	$1,356	$81	6.4%
1995	$1,455	$99	7.3%
1996	$1,682	$227	15.6%
1997	$1,837	$155	9.2%
1998	$1,801	-$36	-2.0%
1999	$1,781	-$20	-1.1%
2000	$1,857	$76	4.3%
2001	$1,926	$69	3.7%
2002	$2,083	$157	8.2%
2003	$2,275	$192	9.2%
2004	$2,629	$354	15.6%
2005	$2,914	$285	10.8%
2006	$3,204	$290	10.0%
2007	$3,908	$704	22.0%
2008	$4,468	$560	14.3%
2009	$4,371	-$97	-2.2%
2010	$5,064	$693	15.9%
2011	$6,708	$1,644	32.5%
2012	$8,296	$1,588	23.7%
2013	$8,716	$420	5.1%
2014	$7,943	-$773	-8.9%
2015	$7,633	-$310	-3.9%
2016	$7,183	-$450	-5.9%
2017	$7,326	$143	2.0%
2018	$7,264	-$62	-0.8%
2019	$7,432	$168	2.3%
2020	$7,559	$127	1.7%
2021	$9,751	$2,192	29.0%
2022	$11,411	$1,660	17.0%
2023	$11,835	$424	3.7%
2024	$11,467	-$369	-3.1%
2025	$11,549	$83	0.7%

Analysis by Crop Reporting District

The highest average land values were reported in Northwest Iowa, $14,522 per acre. The lowest average land values were reported in South Central Iowa, $7,623 per acre.

Land values increased across six of the nine crop reporting districts. The largest percentage increases were in the Northeast and East Central districts, at 4.1% and 3.4%, respectively. The largest declines were in North Central and Central districts at 2.6% and 2.0%, respectively. The West Central district saw the smallest percentage change at an increase of 0.1% followed by Southeast district which reported an increase of 0.5%.

Analysis by Quality of Land

Low-quality land statewide averaged $7,580 per acre, a 1.7% or $130 per acre increase from November 2024. Low-quality land in the Northwest, Northeast, and Southeast saw the largest increases, reported at 6.9%, 5.5%, and 3.3%, respectively; and low-quality land saw decreases in Central, West Central, and North Central district at 1.8%, 1.8%, and 1.4%, respectively.

Medium-quality land averaged $10,809 per acre, an increase of 0.6% or $69 per acre, with four out of nine districts reporting an increase. The largest increase was reported in Northeast at 4.9% or $552 per acre and the largest decrease was reported in South Central district at 5.1% or $399 per acre.

High-quality land averaged $14,030 per acre, an increase of 0.7% or $101 per acre. High-quality saw increases in all districts except North Central and Central which reported a decline of 2.7% and 2.4%, respectively. The largest increases were observed in East Central and Northeast district at 3.4% and 3.1%, or $501 per acre and $447 per acre, respectively.

Major Factors Influencing the Farmland Market

Most survey respondents listed positive and negative factors influencing the land market. Of all respondents, 78% listed at least one positive factor, and 80% listed at least one negative factor. In most cases, respondents listed multiple factors.

There were three positive factors listed by 60% of respondents who provided at least one positive factor. The most frequently mentioned factor was limited land supply, mentioned in 21% of responses.

Strong yields and the combination of cash on hand and credit availability were the next most frequently mentioned positive factors, with 13% and 10% of responses, respectively. Other frequently mentioned positive factors included strong land demand (8%), including from investors (8%), and a strong livestock sector (6%).

There were also three negative factors listed by 58% of respondents who identified at least one negative factor. The most frequently mentioned negative factor affecting land values in 2025 was the fall of commodity prices mentioned in 32% of responses, and the series of interest rate hikes over the past few years was the second most important concern, with 22% of responses identifying it. Concerns about higher input costs (mentioned in 13% of responses), uncertainty due to tariffs and trade (5%) and limited cash and working capital in the farm sector (4%) were the next most frequently mentioned negative factors. Lower yields were mentioned in 3% of responses.

Number of Sales Compared to Previous Year

Forty-two percent of respondents reported fewer sales in 2025 relative to 2024, in line with the downturn in the agricultural economy, as well as the pressure of all the negative factors mentioned above. Only 17% of respondents reported more sales, while 41% reported the same level of sales in 2025 compared to 2024.

Land Sales by Buyer Category

The survey asked respondents what percent of the land was sold to six categories of buyers: existing local farmers, existing relocating farmers, new farmers, local investors, non-local investors, or other.

The majority of farmland sales, 68%, were to existing farmers, of which existing local farmers captured 66% of land sales. Only 2% of sales were to existing relocating farmers. New farmers represented 4% of sales. Investors represented 26% of land sales, with 14% going to local investors and 12% to non-local. Other purchasers accounted for 2% of sales.

Land Sales by Seller Category

The survey also asked respondents what percent of land was sold by each of these six categories of sellers: active farmers, retired farmers, estate sales, local investors, non-local investors, or other.

The majority of farmland sales, 55%, were from estate sales, followed by retired farmers at 22%. Active farmers accounted for 8% of sales, while local and non-local investors accounted for 6% and 7%, respectively.

Estate sales by crop reporting district ranged from 38% in the South Central district to 68% in the Northwest district.

Sales by investors were highest in the South Central and Southwest districts at 23% and 20%, respectively. In the South Central district, local investors represented 11% of sales and non-locals represented another 12%. In the Southwest district, local investors represented 7% of sales and non-locals represented 13%. The Northwest district reported the lowest investor sale activity (4%), with local and non-local investors each representing 2% of sales.

Respondents by Occupation and by Mode of Survey

The survey asked the main occupation of the respondent: farm manager, appraiser, agricultural lender, broker/realtor, government, farmer/landowner, and other, along with the respondents' number of years of experience and the number of counties in which they offer services.

In total, 316 agricultural professionals completed the survey, providing 463 county land value estimates. Of these 316, agricultural lenders represented the largest group, accounting for 28% of all respondents. Brokers/realtors and farm managers were the next largest groups, each representing 17% of respondents.

Across crop reporting districts, the percentage of agricultural lenders ranged from 14% in the South Central district to 40% in the Northwest district.

Our respondents, on average, have 26 years of experience in their current profession and offer professional services to an average of eight counties. While government officials typically only serve one or two counties, appraisers, farm managers, agricultural lenders, and brokers/realtors offer services, on average, to 17, 13, 9, and 4 counties, respectively.

The survey was completed online by 69% of the 316 respondents.

Farmland Value and Cash Crop Price Predictions by Respondents

The survey also asked respondents to predict land values and cash crop prices one and five years from now, as well as the prevailing interest rates for a 20-year farmland mortgage and a one-year operating loan. This year's survey also asked the respondents about their one- and five-year predictions for inflation.

Respondents have optimistic views regarding the strength of the farmland market five years from now and generally expect stable or even higher land values, with the one-year expectation tilting towards a fall in land values. Forty-one percent of respondents forecast a decrease in their local land market in one year, while 31% expected a higher land value, and 28% forecast no change. While the most popular response was for the one-year land price forecast to remain the same (28%), the second-most popular answer was for land values to decrease by 5% or less (27%), and the third-most popular answer was for land values to increase by less than 5% (19%). Looking five years ahead, 10% of respondents forecasted a decline, much smaller than the 41% forecasting a decline 12 months from now. Meanwhile, 82% of respondents expect an increase in land values in the long term, with an increase of 10–20% selected by most respondents (41%).

To better gauge the respondents' views of current farmland values, the survey also asks them to rate the current farmland values in their primary county as way too low, too low, just right, too high, or way too high. Fifty-three percent and 8% of respondents think the current land values are too high or way too high, respectively, while only 3% of respondents think the current land values are low. Thirty-seven percent of respondents think the land values are just right.

Respondents expect corn and soybean cash crop markets to remain relatively stable at their lower prices. In particular, the predicted state average cash corn prices for November 2026 (one year from now) and 2030 (five years from now) are $4.25 per bushel and $4.96 per bushel, respectively. The statewide average soybean price predictions are $10.53 per bushel in one year and $11.96 per bushel five years from now.

Land Quality and Corn Suitability Rating 2

To gauge how each respondent defined high-, medium-, and low-quality land for their county, we asked for estimated average CSR2 (Corn Suitability Rating 2) for high-, medium-, and low-quality land. We also asked for estimates of the percent of land area for each land quality class.

Over 90% of participants provided at least one CSR2 estimate for the corresponding land quality classes. The estimated average CSR2 values statewide for high-, medium-, and low-quality land are 83, 70, and 55 points, respectively. The estimated percentage of land area for high-, medium-, and low-quality land is 35%, 40%, and 25%, respectively.

In addition, respondents ranked high-, medium-, and low-quality land based on relative conditions in their region. For example, the average CSR2 for high-quality land in the South Central district is 70, which is only slightly larger than the CSR2 for low-quality land in the Northwest district (67).

Interpretation of the 2024 Survey Results

The 2025 Iowa State University Land Value Survey reported a 0.7% increase in average Iowa farmland values, bringing the statewide average to $11,549 per acre from November 2024 to November 2025. This represents an increase of $83 per acre from the previous year. Although the 2025 nominal value is lower than last year, it remains 32.5% above the

Table 2. Estimated average CSR2 and percent of land area by land quality, 2025.

	Reported Average CSR2			Reported Percent of Land Area		
	High Quality	Medium Quality	Low Quality	High Quality	Medium Quality	Low Quality
Northwest	90	80	67	43	37	20
North Central	85	73	58	46	34	20
Northeast	85	71	56	35	41	25
West Central	82	70	56	34	43	23
Central	87	74	59	42	35	23
East Central	85	72	56	35	40	24
Southwest	75	62	48	21	49	29
South Central	70	56	42	23	46	31
Southeast	80	65	47	30	36	34
STATE	**83**	**70**	**55**	**35**	**40**	**25**

2013 peak and 2.4% below the 2023 peak. The inflation-adjusted value, $8,475 per acre in 2015 dollars, fell by 1.8% and is now 4.3% below the 2013 peak and 7.2% below the 2023 peak.

A land value change of less than 5%, whether positive or negative, should generally be considered an adjustment rather than a major market shift. All county-level changes fall within this range, which makes 2025 a year of adjustment characterized by reduced sales activity and relative stability. Downward pressure on values continues to stem from lower commodity prices, high interest rates, rising input costs, and uncertainty related to tariffs and trade. At the same time, limited land supply, strong crop yields, high cash and credit availability from recent years, solid demand, including from investors, and improved livestock-sector margins supported the market. In 2024, 31% of respondents expected land values to remain the same or increase only modestly during the following year, and those expectations have now been realized. This year, 47% of respondents expect either slight increases or stability within the next year, and 82% remain optimistic about long-term prospects, anticipating higher land values over the next five years.

The 2025 survey also highlights clear geographic patterns across crop reporting districts, counties, and land quality categories. Land values declined in three of Iowa's nine crop reporting districts, indicating a divided market. The largest increases occurred in the Northeast (+4.1%), East Central (+3.4%), and Northwest (+2.9%) districts. The largest decreases occurred in the North Central (-2.6%) and Central (-2.0%) districts. At the county level, 39 of 99 counties recorded nominal declines, although all were less than 5%. When adjusted for inflation, 78 counties experienced decreases and eight saw reductions greater than 5%. Kossuth County posted the largest nominal decline at 4.3% and the largest inflation-adjusted decline at 6.6%, while Clayton and Allamakee Counties recorded the largest increase at 4.4%. Most counties with decreases were located in central Iowa, while the strongest increases were concentrated in the northeast.

In general, the results from the 2025 Iowa State University Land Value Survey are similar to the results from other surveys, which all highlight modest declines in farmland values due to lower commodity prices and show weak land values in areas concentrated in crop production. In November 2025, the Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, www.chicagofed.org/publications/agletter/2025-2029/november-2025, reported a 1% decline in Iowa's "good" farmland values from October 2024 to October 2025. In September, the REALTORS® Land Institute, www.rliland.com/iowa/Resources/Land-Trends-and-Values, reported an overall 2.2%

decrease in Iowa cropland values from September 2024 to September 2025, with decreases observed in all nine crop reporting districts. On the other hand, the **US Department of Agriculture June Area Survey**, esmis.nal.usda.gov/sites/default/release-files/pn89d6567/2n49w148w/m039n441h/land0825.pdf, reported a 3.9% rise in Iowa's agricultural real estate values (land and building) from June 2024 to June 2025.

Forty-two percent of respondents reported fewer sales in 2025 relative to 2024, while only 17% of respondents reported more sales. Forty-one percent reported the same level of sales in 2025 compared to 2024. The majority of farmland sales, 55%, were from estate sales, followed by retired farmers at 22%.

Active farmers accounted for 8% of sales, while local and non-local investors accounted for 6% and 7%, respectively.

The farmland value estimates from the Iowa State survey are average estimates for all farmland in a county, including cropland, pasture, CRP, and timberland. Specifically, we asked respondents to estimate "farmland value for average-sized farms in your county as of November 1, 2025."

An opinion survey is just that—it represents the collective opinion of the survey respondents. Most of the respondents will use actual sales to formulate their opinions but each person can choose to weigh or discount particular sales as they deem necessary. The Iowa State Land Value Survey is an opinion survey, as are the surveys conducted by the Federal Reserve Bank, USDA, and the REALTORS® Land Institute. It is important to consider the survey respondents, the questions asked, the time period covered, and other factors relating to a particular survey. As a result, it is important to note that when comparing results across surveys for Iowa and neighboring states, it is better to compare percentage change over time as opposed to dollar amount per acre.

The Iowa State Land Value Survey is intended to provide information on general land value trends and factors influencing the Iowa land market, it is not intended to provide a direct estimate for any particular piece of property. We recommend interested buyers or sellers hire an appraiser to conduct a formal appraisal of a particular parcel, go to county assessor websites, or examine recent auction results for comparable parcels in their region.

Short-term challenges of lower profitability, persistent cost pressures, and tight credit conditions are weighing on Iowa's farmland market. Yet the sector remains fundamentally supported by strong balance sheets, with 84% of Iowa farmland owned debt-free, and by farm incomes that continue to exceed long-term norms. Farmland is increasingly viewed as a robust and stable investment option amid broader economic and geopolitical uncertainty. In the short term, farmland markets face pressures from declining commodity prices, high costs, and high interest rates. However, the long-term outlook remains positive, with the market expected to remain stable until it turns strong again.

Full details of the survey and data visualizations can be found on the **CARD website**, https://farmland.card.iastate.edu/. Historical data can be downloaded from the AgDM Decision Tool **Historical Iowa Farmland Values Data**, https://go.iastate.edu/AGDMC270LV, or in AgDM File C2-72, **Historical Iowa Farmland Values**, https://go.iastate.edu/AGDMC272.

Table 3. Average value per acre of Iowa farmland listed by crop reporting districts and quality of land.

Year	State Average	North-west	North Central	Northeast	West Central	Central	East Central	South-west	South Central	Southeast
					All farmland					
2013	8716	10960	9818	9161	9449	9877	9327	7531	4791	6994
2014	7943	9615	8536	8151	8424	9087	9008	6513	4475	7215
2015	7633	9685	7962	7861	8061	8505	8506	6372	4397	6892
2016	7183	9243	7562	7313	7358	7841	7917	6060	4241	6716
2017	7326	9388	7802	7543	7377	8097	8218	6058	4172	6864
2018	7264	9311	7789	7543	7413	7899	8004	6060	4329	6619
2019	7432	9352	7912	7325	7564	8336	8475	6166	4487	6868
2020	7559	9536	7927	7525	7859	8485	8524	6112	4658	6935
2021	9751	12164	10664	9958	10461	10744	11051	7582	6035	8451
2022	11411	14878	12449	11627	12411	12582	12595	9264	6824	9276
2023	11835	14753	12818	12060	12741	13014	12678	9505	7482	10460
2024	11467	14109	12185	11884	11798	12794	12354	9340	7754	10285
2025	11549	14522	11870	12365	11806	12537	12772	9460	7623	10337
					High quality					
2013	10828	12824	11159	11423	11591	11803	11631	9591	7150	9785
2014	9854	11201	9630	10083	10275	10780	11034	8482	6663	10150
2015	9364	11229	8976	9575	9684	10087	10289	8031	6445	9536
2016	8758	10650	8442	8892	8874	9299	9502	7527	5980	9265
2017	8933	10829	8730	9151	8881	9568	9900	7571	5908	9471
2018	8863	10767	8699	9198	8834	9313	9768	7738	6055	9063
2019	9078	10757	8858	9050	9017	9749	10421	7768	6416	9341
2020	9068	10780	8889	9182	9159	9800	10199	7484	6408	9299
2021	11834	13997	12064	12308	12289	12512	13503	9424	8194	11628
2022	13817	17121	14271	13806	14821	14720	15097	11419	9478	12829
2023	14296	16938	14719	14617	14950	15531	15593	11884	9718	14157
2024	13930	16171	13919	14323	13891	15039	14941	11728	10659	14088
2025	14030	16519	13537	14769	13979	14679	15442	11965	10677	14179
					Medium quality					
2013	8047	9918	8824	8573	8725	8930	8567	7137	4715	6605
2014	7359	8698	7874	7591	7827	8327	8388	6108	4318	6715
2015	7127	8834	7352	7460	7581	7758	7934	6038	4282	6525
2016	6705	8468	6992	6994	6870	7186	7396	5683	4128	6283
2017	6849	8555	7218	7236	6824	7426	7674	5756	4079	6548
2018	6805	8548	7214	7116	6935	7341	7452	5671	4244	6353
2019	6938	8633	7248	6833	7076	7649	7823	5841	4371	6616
2020	7119	8993	7350	6980	7433	7883	7959	5843	4563	6639
2021	9071	11042	9641	9122	9700	9980	10179	7145	6094	8169
2022	10673	13710	11171	11122	11654	11527	11876	8769	6872	8677
2023	11075	13731	11512	11364	12018	11807	11862	9102	7498	9858
2024	10740	12975	11003	11169	11090	11806	11497	8794	7864	9843
2025	10809	13507	10808	11720	11062	11583	11961	8850	7465	9731
					Low quality					
2013	5298	6845	6421	5670	5926	5918	5449	4592	2843	3651
2014	4878	6091	5428	5256	5173	5582	5479	3860	2808	3891
2015	4834	6252	5372	5242	5082	5292	5366	4070	2750	3797
2016	4665	6019	5164	4847	4577	5158	5153	4189	2892	3783
2017	4689	6216	5265	4965	4684	4993	5305	3935	2824	3768
2018	4609	6018	5161	5056	4720	4932	4911	3790	2953	3656
2019	4759	6099	5325	4803	4950	5467	5279	3844	2955	3790
2020	5078	6486	5297	5213	5492	5793	5599	4055	3262	4134
2021	6397	8088	6992	6717	7044	7136	7215	5155	4058	4734
2022	7369	9569	7849	8047	8161	7927	8441	6081	4379	5406
2023	7664	9497	8045	7965	9084	7917	8087	6131	5105	6357
2024	7450	9162	7693	8120	8041	8321	8328	5965	5071	5868
2025	7580	9792	7587	8571	7899	8170	8340	6116	5199	6062

Figure 2. 2025 Iowa land values by county and percentage change.

State Average Values
Nov 2025: $11,549 (0.7%)
Nov 2024: $11,467

County estimates of average dollar value per acre for Iowa farmland based on US Census of Agriculture estimates and the Nov. 1, 2025, Iowa Land Value Survey conducted by Center for Agricultural and Rural Development, Iowa State University and Iowa State University Extension and Outreach. The top figure is the estimated Nov. 1, 2025, value; the bottom figure is the percentage of change from the estimated Nov. 1, 2024 value.

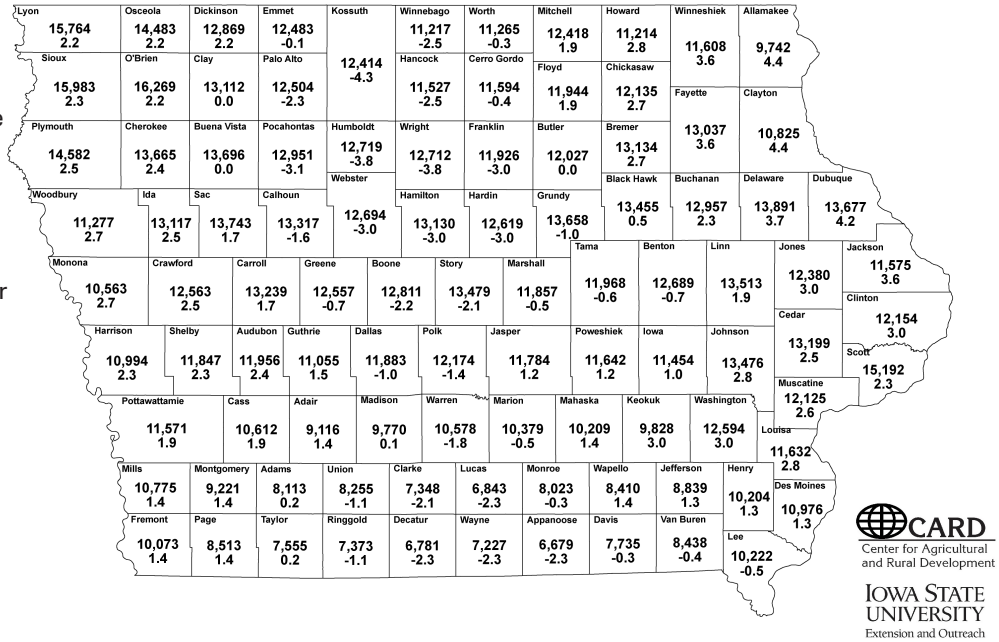
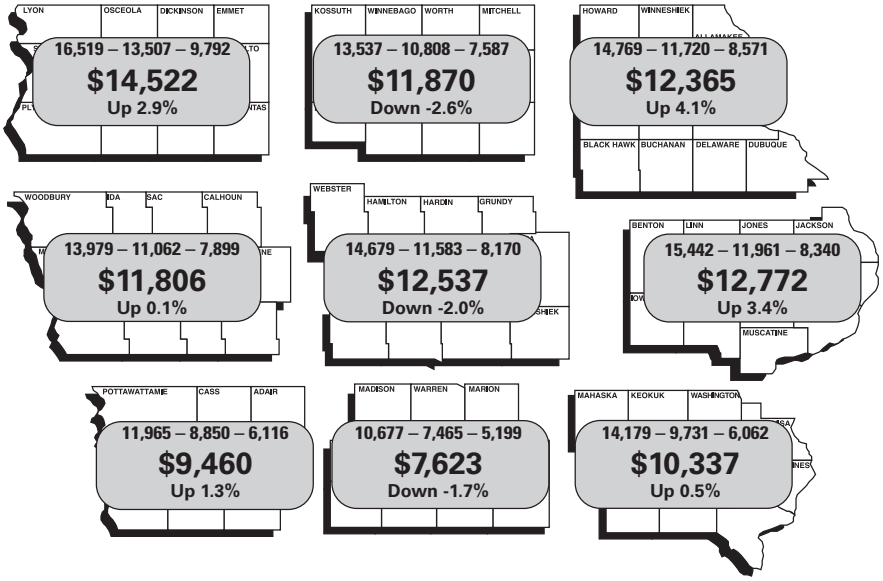


Figure 3. 2025 Iowa land values by crop reporting district.



Estimates of average dollar value per acre for high, medium, and low quality farmland (top row) on Nov. 1, 2025, by Iowa Crop Reporting District; the Crop Reporting District average (middle row); and the average percentage change from Nov. 1, 2024 (bottom row). The estimates are based on a survey conducted by Iowa State University, Center for Agricultural and Rural Development, and Iowa State University Extension and Outreach.

Average by quality, statewide:
High-quality, $14,030
Medium-quality, $10,809
Low-quality, $7,580

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By Rabail Chandio, assistant professor and extension economist, Iowa State University
rchandio@iastate.edu

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